



Why the World Is Turning Away From American Agriculture

【彭博社：为什么世界正在远离美国农业 | 20250714】

Summary: The article explores the challenges facing American farmers, including declining exports, rising costs, and reliance on government subsidies, while highlighting the generational legacy and technological advancements in U.S. agriculture.

摘要： 文章探讨了美国农民面临的挑战，包括出口下降、成本上升和对政府补贴的依赖，同时强调了美国农业的代际传承和技术进步。



🕒 Estimated Reading Time: 36 min

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- 00:18:33 You've got to make sure that that's taken care of.
- 00:19:24 And that can be true in a variety of ways.
- 00:19:46 And the market starts to take risks that end up becoming mis
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- 00:20:50 President Trump's Secretary of Agriculture, Brooke Rollins,
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▶ Since 1933, the government, your government, has been a friend of the farmer.

自1933年以来，政府，你们的政府，一直是农民的朋友。

▶ Farmers? Farmers, US farmers. America's farmers.

农民？农民，美国的农民。美国的农民们。

▶ And I love them, and I'm never going to do anything to hurt our farmers.

我爱他们，我永远不会做任何伤害我们农民的事。

▶ Welcome to Iowa, where dusty roads pierced through over 20 million acres of corn and soybeans.

欢迎来到爱荷华州，尘土飞扬的道路穿过2000多万英亩的玉米和大豆田。

▶ The towns are small, and the skyscrapers, dotting the horizon, aren't office buildings, but grain elevators.

小镇很小，点缀在地平线上的“摩天大楼”不是办公楼，而是谷仓。

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▶ This is America's heartland, and farming runs in the blood.

这是美国的心脏地带，农业流淌在血液中。

▶ I am the third generation.

我是第三代。

▶ My grandfather started farming in Nebraska for Generation 1, and in the mid-50s moved here to Central Iowa, and my father continued, and then now me after.

我祖父是第一代，在内布拉斯加州开始务农，50年代中期搬到爱荷华州中部，我父亲继承了他的事业，现在轮到我。

▶ What brought your grandfather to Iowa?

是什么让你祖父来到爱荷华州？

▶ The situation in Nebraska was three brothers farming together.

当时内布拉斯加州的情况是三个兄弟一起务农。

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▶ They weren't able to accumulate enough acres, and then drought situations in Nebraska decided that they should split up.

他们无法积累足够的土地，内布拉斯加州的干旱迫使他们分家。

▶ My grandfather moved to Sioux City, Iowa originally, and farmed there for a couple years.

我祖父最初搬到了爱荷华州的苏城，在那里耕种了几年。

▶ Started a dairy herd. That didn't work out, so then there was an opportunity to rent and buy this farm.

他尝试养奶牛，但没有成功，后来有机会租下并买下这个农场。

▶ Are you hoping your children will continue in the farming business in some way?

你希望你的孩子以某种方式继续从事农业吗？

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▶ I certainly do, and I think that that was something that I'm very proud of to pass on that tradition, that appreciation for agriculture to all of my kids.

我当然希望，而且我非常自豪能将这种传统、对农业的热爱传递给我的孩子们。

▶ This I have not done.

这一点我还没有做到。

▶ That's Stu Swanson.

这是斯图·斯旺森。

▶ His farming family has seen dramatic changes in the business of agriculture since his grandfather came from Nebraska 75 years ago.

自他祖父75年前从内布拉斯加州搬来以来，他的农业家族见证了农业领域的巨大变化。

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▶ So each acre of corn will cover three times with this machine?

所以这台机器能让每英亩玉米的产量翻三倍？

▶ Over that time, US farm productivity and output has nearly tripled, helped by technological innovations.

在此期间，得益于技术创新，美国农业的生产力和产量几乎翻了三倍。

▶ With that explosion and productivity has come larger and larger farms, including for Swanson, who now farms about 1900 acres, a third of which he owns with the rest owned by investors from as far away as Norway.

随着生产力的爆发，农场规模越来越大，斯旺森现在耕种约1900英亩土地，其中三分之一归他所有，其余由远至挪威的投资者拥有。

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⏮ Yeah, I think for this time of the year in mid-June, the corn looks about as good as any.

是的，我认为在六月中旬的这个时节，玉米长势非常好。

⏮ I've farmed for 33 years, so this is my 33rd crop that you're walking through today, other than a little excess water that we've had in the last few days.

我务农33年了，所以这是你看到的第33茬庄稼，只是最近几天雨水有点多。

⏮ Well, I was just saying my boots are sinking down here, so we walk through it.

嗯，我刚才说我的靴子陷进去了，所以我们得小心走。

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⏮ But also, look at the color of the soil.

不过，看看这土壤的颜色。

⏮ Why is this so rich?

为什么这么肥沃？

⏮ We're lucky that the glaciers moved the top soil here.

我们很幸运，冰川把表土带到了这里。

⏮ We also are in an area of Iowa and in the country that is called the Peri Potole region.

我们还位于爱荷华州和全国被称为“Peri Potole”的地区。

▶ So we have really rich organic soils from the previous plants and things that were grown here.

因此，我们有非常肥沃的有机土壤，来自之前在这里生长的植物。

▶ And so that high organic matter gives that black color that we are very proud of here in Wright County.

这种高有机质含量让土壤呈现黑色，这是我们在赖特县引以为豪的。

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▶ That might all sound like good news.

这一切听起来像是好消息。

▶ But as president of the Iowa Corn Growers Association, Swanson knows all too well the challenges facing America's row crop farmers.

但作为爱荷华州玉米种植者协会的主席，斯旺森非常清楚美国大田作物农民面临的挑战。

▶ A lot of farms I understand are actually cash negative.

据我所知，许多农场实际上是现金负流入。

▶ Are you cash positive?

你的农场是正现金流吗？

▶ I have it ran a number to tell you today.

我今天可以给你算算。

▶ Certainly, we know that over the last three years, we've seen about a 30% decline in commodity prices.

当然，我们知道过去三年大宗商品价格下跌了约30%。

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▶ I think over that same time, we've seen the nine major crops all be underwater, so we are producing at a loss on the nine major crops.

我认为在同一时期，九种主要作物都在亏损，所以我们是在亏本生产。

▶ Gold Eagle Cooperative is an intermediary for farmers in the markets they serve.

金鹰合作社是农民与市场之间的中介。

▶ It is located on the outskirts of Eagle Grove, a short 20-minute drive up the road from Swanson's farm.

它位于鹰林镇郊外，距离斯旺森的农场只有20分钟车程。

▶ We sat down there with Tom Halverson, an Iowa native himself.

我们与汤姆·霍尔沃森坐下来交谈，他是土生土长的爱荷华人。

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▶ I remember when my grandfather started, when I was a little kid, he had a little tractor with a harvester that would do one on each side.

我记得我祖父刚开始务农时，我还是个孩子，他有一台小型拖拉机，两边各有一个收割机。

▶ He'd be going back and forth and it would feel like this for a couple days.

他会来回开，感觉要花好几天。

▶ After working around the world for Goldman Sachs, he's now CEO of Cobank, which operates as a farm credit bank, counting his clients both Swanson's farm and Gold Eagle.

在高盛全球工作后， he 现在是Cobank的首席执行官，这是一家农业信贷银行，客户包括斯旺森的农场和金鹰合作社。

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▶ Halverson has a front row seat for the storm brewing over America's crop farms.

霍尔沃森近距离目睹了美国农作物农场面临的风暴。

▶ Corn, soybean and wheat prices are meaningfully lower than they were a couple of years ago.

玉米、大豆和小麦的价格比几年前低得多。

▶ That translates into lower cash flows for the producers themselves.

这意味着生产者的现金流减少。

▶ At the same time, rural Americans in general and farmers in particular are not immune from macroeconomic conditions, including inflation, for example.

与此同时，美国农村地区，尤其是农民，无法免受宏观经济条件的影响，比如通货膨胀。

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▶ They are incredibly exposed to trade buying and selling internationally.

他们在国际贸易中非常脆弱。

▶ Producers have been squeezed quite dramatically over the last 12, 18, 24 months by a combination of lower commodity prices for what they sell on the one hand and significantly higher prices for the inputs.

过去12、18、24个月，生产者受到双重挤压：一方面他们出售的商品价格下降，另一方面投入成本大幅上升。

▶ Once seen as the supermarket of the world, America is instead finding out the hard way that the world is doing its grocery shopping elsewhere and has been for some time.

美国曾被视为世界的超市，但现在却艰难地发现，世界正在其他地方购买农产品，而且已经持续了一段时间。

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▶ This year, the U.S. is expected to record its third consecutive annual trade deficit in agriculture.

今年，美国预计将连续第三年出现农业贸易逆差。

▶ Something that hasn't happened in 70 years.

这是70年来首次。

▶ Javier Blas covers commodities for Bloomberg opinion.

哈维尔·布拉斯为彭博观点撰写大宗商品专栏。

▶ I think that the reversal on the agricultural trade in the United States is a structural feature.

我认为美国农业贸易的逆转是一个结构性特征。

▶ I don't think it's going to go away.

我认为这种情况不会消失。

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▶ There are two elements there that they are very important.

有两个非常重要的因素。

▶ One is that the United States is importing more agricultural commodities that they used to.

一是美国进口的农产品比以前更多。

▶ And the reason for that is that we like to have green beans and strawberries and other agricultural crops the whole year.

原因是我们希望全年都能吃到青豆、草莓和其他农产品。

▶ We don't really want to buy them when they are in season.

我们并不想在应季时才购买。

▶ The other problem is that the United States is started to export less agricultural commodities and that is a lot in part due to Mr. Trump's trade policies.

另一个问题是美国开始出口更少的农产品，这在很大程度上是由于特朗普的贸易政策。

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▶ You are hurting one of your largest buyers, one of the largest importers, one of the largest customers of American food industry that's China.

你们正在伤害最大的买家之一、最大的进口商之一、美国食品行业最大的客户之一——中国。

▶ The big problem for the United States agricultural sector right now is that in the past, if a country was having a big disagreement on trade policy with the United States, it still needed to continue buying corn and soybean and wheat from America.

美国农业部门现在面临的大问题是，过去如果一个国家与美国在贸易政策上存在重大分歧，它仍然需要继续从美国购买玉米、大豆和小麦。

▶ Because it didn't have any other options.

因为它没有其他选择。

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▶ Today, there are many other options, and particularly one, and it's Brazil.

如今，有许多其他选择，尤其是巴西。

▶ Brazil, over the last 40 years, have transformed itself into the supermarket of the world.

巴西在过去40年里已经将自己转变为世界的超市。

▶ That is a role that the United States used to play in the 60s, 70s, and all the way into the 80s.

这是美国在60年代、70年代一直到80年代扮演的角色。

▶ The damage is done every time the U.S. scared buyers.

每次美国吓跑买家，都会造成损害。

▶ The buyers are looking for an alternative, and they will have very long memories.

买家会寻找替代方案，而且他们会记很久。

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▶ Japanese soil imports, as I still remember, the very brief trade embargo imposed by the United States more than 50 years ago on soybeans.

我记得日本土壤进口，50多年前美国对大豆实施的短暂贸易禁运。

▶ That is half a century later, the buyers still remember that.

半个世纪后，买家仍然记得。

▶ Once you open that door, you cannot put it back.

一旦你打开这扇门，就无法关上。

▶ It has been done, and I think the damage is done.

事情已经发生，我认为损害已经造成。

▶ As far into the future as we can foresee, the agricultural economy of the United States is very, very dependent on access to overseas export markets.

在可预见的未来，美国的农业经济非常依赖海外出口市场。

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▶ My uncle who lived about a mile from where we're right now sitting was one of the first American farmers to go on a trade mission to China in the late 1970s.

我叔叔住在离我们现在坐的地方大约一英里的地方，他是70年代末首批前往中国进行贸易考察的美国农民之一。

▶ Back then, we didn't sell any soybeans to China.

那时，我们没有向中国出售任何大豆。

▶ And since that time, we've grown our export market to China from zero to being the biggest export market.

从那时起，我们对中国的出口市场从零增长到最大的出口市场。

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▶ Until our recent trade disagreements with China, we got up to the point where it wasn't yet 50%, but it was closing on 50% of all U.S. soybeans got exported to China, which is an inconceivably large amount of soybeans that are being grown in this part of the world.

直到最近与中国的贸易分歧，我们对中国的出口接近美国大豆总量的50%，这是一个难以想象的巨大数量。

▶ Put on trains, ship to the West Coast, put on ships and sent to China.

装上火车，运到西海岸，再装上船运往中国。

▶ And so we now have a very significant vulnerability to the need to sell our soybeans internationally because we produce way more soybeans now than we possibly consume in this country.

因此，我们现在非常依赖国际市场来销售大豆，因为我们的产量远远超过国内消费量。

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▶ With China and others now looking elsewhere, the U.S. is finding ways to drum up domestic demand.

随着中国和其他国家转向其他地方，美国正在想办法刺激国内需求。

▶ Part of the answer lies in alternative uses, and that's where Chris Bochart, the CEO of Gold Eagle, comes in.

部分答案在于替代用途，这就是金鹰公司首席执行官克里斯·博查特的用武之地。

▶ We're about a 3,000-member-owned cooperative.

我们是一个拥有约3000名成员的合作社。

▶ We provide goods and services to farmers, so we provide a lot of agronomy, services, real-cell farmers seed, fertilizers, crop protection products to help their crops grow.

我们为农民提供商品和服务，包括农艺服务、种子、肥料和作物保护产品，帮助他们的作物生长。

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▶ Our feed group will take farmer corn and grind that, blend that, and feed that back out to livestock.

我们的饲料部门将农民的玉米磨碎、混合，然后喂给牲畜。

▶ And then our green division, we take the farmers corn in the fall, or whenever they need us to be there to deliver it, we try to help and find the best markets.

我们的绿色部门在秋季或其他需要时接收农民的玉米，并帮助他们找到最佳市场。

▶ We do have a partnership with an ethanol plant, so we manage an ethanol plant that's just right out the back door here.

我们与一家乙醇工厂合作，管理着附近的一家乙醇工厂。

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▶ We grind about 30 million bushels of corn a year, we're making about 90 million gallons of ethanol out of that corn, ship it in all over the country for into our liquid fuel supply.

我们每年研磨约3000万蒲式耳玉米，生产约9000万加仑乙醇，运往全国各地供应液体燃料。

▶ When you and I think of corn, we may think of corn on the cob, corn chips, corn starch, or even popcorn.

当你我想到玉米时，可能会想到玉米棒、玉米片、玉米淀粉甚至爆米花。

▶ But only about 8% of the corn America produces is eaten by humans.

但美国生产的玉米中只有约8%供人类食用。

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▶ The majority is crushed and turned into livestock feed, or processed into ethanol and used in gasoline.

大部分被压碎制成牲畜饲料，或加工成乙醇用于汽油。

▶ We think that the ethanol policy gets debated around from time to time.

我们认为乙醇政策不时引发争论。

▶ The current administration talks a lot about domestic energy production and has been really good for biofuels.

现任政府经常谈论国内能源生产，这对生物燃料非常有利。

▶ And we've seen biofuels be a real bipartisan solution over our history and it's really been good.

在我们的历史上，生物燃料一直是两党共同的解决方案，效果很好。

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▶ And so as far as corn to man today, where corn to man can grow into the future, we really think that there's a huge potential for ethanol to continue to be a bigger and bigger part of that local demand.

因此，就玉米对人类的作用而言，我们认为乙醇在未来本地需求中的潜力巨大。

▶ The same transition from food to fuel is happening for soy.

大豆也在经历从食品到燃料的转变。

▶ Now we're trying to find alternative uses, for example, to those soybeans, some of which can be turned into alternative sources of fuel.

现在我们正在寻找大豆的替代用途，比如将其转化为替代燃料。

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▶ So for example, the government announced some changes to the renewable fuel standards and so forth that have been very, very good for the soybean market.

例如，政府宣布了可再生燃料标准的调整，这对大豆市场非常有利。

▶ But that may be only half the story.

但这可能只是故事的一半。

▶ As farmers reel from a challenging export market, higher interest rates have delivered a second blow in what turns out to be a pretty capital intensive business.

在农民面临出口市场挑战的同时，更高的利率对这个资本密集型行业造成了第二重打击。

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▶ The high horse power tractors in new situation is probably \$600 to \$700,000.

新型大马力拖拉机的价格可能在60万到70万美元之间。

▶ This machine was actually built in 2009.

这台机器实际上是2009年制造的。

▶ It's probably the oldest piece of equipment that we utilize in a regular basis.

这可能是我们日常使用的最老的设备。

▶ So its value as it sits today, probably \$150,000 to \$175,000.

所以它现在的价值可能在15万到17.5万美元之间。

▶ How fast did they depreciate?

它们的贬值速度有多快？

▶ Yeah, really fast.

是的，非常快。

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⏮ Farming is such a capital intensive endeavor, whether it's the cost of finance, their land acquisitions, just their interest rate to put the operating loan in, to put a crop in.

农业是一个资本密集型行业，无论是融资成本、土地购置，还是运营贷款或种植作物的利率。

⏮ They're investing hundreds of dollars in acres just in the input side to put the crop in.

他们每英亩要投入数百美元，仅用于种植作物的投入。

⏮ And then their machinery and equipment purchases have just really skyrocketed in the last three years.

过去三年间，他们的机械设备采购量确实激增。

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⏮ In the cornfields of Iowa, farming is more than just a business.

在爱荷华州的玉米地里，农业不仅仅是一门生意。

⏮ It's a way of life passed down from generation to generation.

它是一种代代相传的生活方式。

⏮ So do you come from a family of farmers?

那么你来自一个农民家庭吗？

⏮ I do, I'm the third generation.

是的，我是第三代。

▶ I've born on a farm in Southeast Iowa.

我出生在爱荷华州东南部的一个农场。

▶ My grandfather came here, you couldn't farm very much in this part of the state because it was all water.

我祖父来到这里时，这片地区大部分是水域，无法耕种。

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▶ It was wetlands.

这里是湿地。

▶ This is where I grew up and I'm the fifth generation.

这是我长大的地方，我是第五代。

▶ So we're raising this sixth generation here on this farm.

现在我们在这片农场养育第六代。

▶ So back in the late 1800s, my great grandparents would have came here and started the farm.

追溯到19世纪末，我的曾祖父母来到这里并建立了农场。

▶ JD Myers Farm lies a short drive from Stu Swanson's.

JD Myers的农场距离Stu Swanson的农场只有很短的车程。

▶ You'll start seeing, I don't know if we can see it yet, but you'll start seeing a near shoot.

你会开始看到，虽然现在可能还看不到，但很快就能看到新芽。

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▶ And he too farms corn and soybeans, but where Swanson is the third generation in his family growing row crops, JD Myers is fifth generation and plans on passing it along to his own son.

他也种植玉米和大豆，但Swanson是家族中第三代种植行作作物的人，而JD Myers是第五代，并计划将农场传给自己的儿子。

▶ You're on a bushel on the bottom of that bend that's laughed.

你正处在那个弯道的底部，那里有些松动。

▶ So take a few loads to get up there.

所以需要多运几趟才能上去。

▶ But other than that, we'll be done and then we can grease the shivers and get it ready to go.

除此之外，我们就能完成，然后给部件上油，准备继续工作。

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▶ For decades, passing it on to the next generation has been the story of American farms.

几十年来，美国农场的故事一直是代代相传。

▶ But the agricultural workforce has been in steady decline from 8 million in 1949 to just over 2 million today.

但农业劳动力从1949年的800万持续下降到如今的200万多一点。

▶ Technological innovation has certainly made farming more efficient, but urbanization has also contributed.

技术创新确实提高了农业效率，但城市化也起到了推波助澜的作用。

▶ As folks have moved into the cities and we even see that here in Iowa, you know, there's definitely an urbanization trend.

随着人们搬进城市，甚至在爱荷华州也能看到明显的城市化趋势。

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▶ And that's all good.

这都很好。

▶ I mean, that's that's all good and well.

我是说，这些都很好。

▶ But I think that the value of folks really truly understanding where their food and fuel come from.

但我认为，人们真正理解食物和燃料来源的价值非常重要。

▶ There's just tremendous value there.

这其中蕴含着巨大的价值。

▶ And we got it.

我们明白这一点。

▶ We need to keep doing that as as ag leaders to keep telling that story.

作为农业领导者，我们需要继续讲述这个故事。

▶ But if Iowa's farming families hope to pass their way of life onto the next generation, it has to be a sound business as well as a way of life.

但如果爱荷华州的农民家庭希望将他们的生活方式传给下一代，它必须既是稳定的生意，也是一种生活方式。

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▶ And the combination of low prices and higher costs has meant that farm income has plummeted over the past few years, meaning that sometimes financial institutions like Cobank have to make up the difference through loans.

低价和高成本的结合导致农场收入在过去几年暴跌，这意味着有时像Cobank这样的金融机构不得不通过贷款弥补差额。

▶ We rely not only on Cobank, but local banks to help provide financing.

我们不仅依赖Cobank，还依赖当地银行提供融资。

▶ The cost of production is at such a high level and it just keeps increasing.

生产成本处于如此高的水平，而且还在不断上升。

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▶ That we need that backstop to know that we can we can average cash flows out.

我们需要这种保障，以确保我们能平衡现金流。

▶ One of the most important indicators of credit quality for the farm credit system, and indirectly for farmers as well, is farmland value.

衡量农业信贷系统信用质量的最重要指标之一，间接对农民也很重要，是农田价值。

▶ Right?

对吧？

▶ So we watch very carefully what's happening to farmland value.

所以我们非常仔细地关注农田价值的变化。

▶ My family owns some, so we watch it too.

我家拥有一些农田，所以我们也在关注。

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⏮ And farmland values are always a massively lagging indicator.

而农田价值总是一个严重滞后的指标。

⏮ Commodity prices have come down a lot, right?

大宗商品价格下降了很多，对吧？

⏮ Corn's down, beans down, wheat's down since the peak two years ago.

玉米、大豆和小麦的价格都比两年前的峰值下降了。

⏮ But farmland value is still like this.

但农田价值仍然如此。

⏮ It has sort of stopped rising in the way that it had been rising for a long time.

它已经停止了长期以来的上涨趋势。

⏮ But as you can imagine, if prices stay low and cash flows are negative for a lot of producers, they don't have free cash flow and working capital and they have to draw down, because farmers tend to be asset rich and cash poor, right?

但可以想象，如果价格保持低位，许多生产者的现金流为负，他们没有自由现金流和营运资金，不得不动用储备，因为农民往往是资产富有但现金匮乏，对吧？

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▶ They own land and physical assets and machinery and stuff that's worth things, but it's not liquid.

他们拥有土地、实物资产和机械设备等有价值的东西，但这些资产缺乏流动性。

▶ So credit quality is actually pretty good balance sheets of most farmers were in good shape until the last 12 to 18 months.

因此，直到过去12到18个月，大多数农民的资产负债表状况良好，信用质量实际上相当不错。

▶ But this, this stress period that we're now in is going to manifest over coming, you know, six, 12, 18 months, and that'll show up in tougher cash flows, people needing to raise liquidity in other ways.

但我们目前所处的压力期将在未来6、12、18个月内显现，表现为更严峻的现金流问题，人们需要通过其他方式筹集流动性。

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▶ Farmers can't keep borrowing forever to make up shortfalls, but there are signs that things could turn around, not because of higher prices or lower costs, but because of the government.

农民不能永远靠借贷弥补短缺，但有迹象表明情况可能好转，不是因为价格上涨或成本下降，而是因为政府。

▶ Something farmers like JD would rather not rely on.

这是像JD这样的农民宁愿不依赖的。

▶ Big scene, you know, I guess for me as a farmer is I want to make sure we have markets.

对我来说，作为一个农民，最重要的是确保我们有市场。

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▶ I don't want direct payments.

我不想要直接补贴。

▶ I would rather not have direct payments from the government.

我宁愿不依赖政府的直接补贴。

▶ If we can have markets that will buy the grain and stuff from us, not have to depend on the government for and develop those markets.

如果我们有市场可以购买我们的谷物等产品，而不必依赖政府，并发展这些市场。

▶ We don't want to rely on government payments.

我们不想依赖政府补贴。

▶ That's the last thing that we want to do.

这是我们最不愿意做的事。

▶ We've worked to try to eliminate that, and we want to try to create demand through domestic markets, through exports to offset that.

我们努力消除这一点，并希望通过国内市场和出口创造需求来抵消它。

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▶ Last year, the US government paid out roughly \$9 billion to farmers.

去年，美国政府向农民支付了约90亿美元。

▶ This year, that figure is set to surge to an estimated \$42 billion.

今年，这一数字预计将激增至约420亿美元。

▶ Much of it aimed at weather-related disaster relief and support for those in financial distress.

其中大部分用于与天气相关的灾害救济和财务困难支持。

⏮ Still, the role of subsidies raises tough questions.

尽管如此，补贴的作用仍引发棘手问题。

⏮ After all, the US didn't bail out DVD manufacturers when streaming upended the industry, but then again, DVDs are a luxury, while food is a necessity.

毕竟，当流媒体颠覆行业时，美国没有救助DVD制造商，但DVD是奢侈品，而食品是必需品。

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⏮ Now, your viewers who are not close to this would probably say, well, why do we do that?

现在，不熟悉此事的观众可能会问，我们为什么要这样做？

⏮ And how much do we do that?

我们做了多少？

⏮ And what's the explanation for that?

对此有何解释？

⏮ To which the answer is, if you travel around the world, as I have in my career, you realize and know that feeding your population is a national security consideration for everyone on Earth.

答案是，如果你像我一样周游世界，你会意识到并明白，养活本国人口是地球上每个人的国家安全考量。

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▶ We kind of take that for granted here, because we're so productive in our agricultural economy.

我们在这里对此习以为常，因为我们的农业经济非常高效。

▶ We don't just feed ourselves.

我们不仅养活自己。

▶ We feed a lot of other people all around the world.

我们还养活世界各地的许多人。

▶ But being able to have a food self-sufficiency and a comprehensive, productive, safe, secure sources on a through-the-cycle basis of food and fiber for the United States of America is, frankly, a matter of a fundamental and vital national security interest.

坦率地说，能够为美利坚合众国提供食品和纤维的自给自足、全面、高效、安全、可靠的来源，是一个根本且至关重要的国家安全利益问题。

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▶ And in order to safeguard that, we have put in place over many decades in this country a whole bunch of support infrastructure to ensure that we will be able to feed our population under any and all circumstances.

为了保护这一点，几十年来，我们在这个国家建立了一整套支持基础设施，以确保我们在任何情况下都能养活我们的人民。

▶ And that infrastructure has been enormously successful for so long that almost all Americans take it for granted.

这一基础设施长期以来非常成功，以至于几乎所有的美国人都认为这是理所当然的。

▶ Is there also a risk in terms of business and the economy in ongoing subsidies to farmers?

持续的农民补贴在商业和经济方面是否存在风险？

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 It's a very important question.

这是一个非常重要的问题。

 I never met a farmer that wants to make a living at the expense of their fellow tax paying citizens.

我从未见过一个农民希望以牺牲其他纳税公民的利益为生。

 That is a true statement.

这是事实。

 On the other hand, just like every other advanced industrialized country in our peer group, so I think Japan, France, UK, Germany, or whatever, because of the national security implications and so forth, you've got to have a good stable food supply.

另一方面，就像我们同行中的其他先进工业化国家一样，比如日本、法国、英国、德国等，出于国家安全等方面的考虑，你必须有一个良好稳定的食品供应。

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 You've got to make sure that that's taken care of.

你必须确保这一点得到保障。

 So you can't leave that 100% to the vagaries of the marketplace.

所以你不能100%依赖市场的变幻莫测。

 And so it's not a surprise, therefore, that all of our peer countries have a similar kinds of mechanisms in place to ensure that and to ensure the care and well-being of the rural land.

因此，我们所有的同行国家都有类似的机制来确保这一点，并确保农村土地的照料和福祉，这并不奇怪。

▶ Having said all of that, it is a risk that if you take too much too often and get your significant risks taken off the table for you whenever they manifest by the government that you become your subject to the risk of the complacency of thinking that that's always going to happen.

话虽如此，如果你过于频繁地接受补贴，每当重大风险出现时都由政府为你消除，你就会面临自满的风险，认为这种情况总会发生。

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▶ And that can be true in a variety of ways.

这在很多方面都是如此。

▶ And I think in our country, in our society, these days there is a tendency for the population to want the government to de-risk things when they go wrong.

我认为，在我们国家和社会中，如今有一种趋势，即人们希望政府在事情出错时降低风险。

▶ All those things are legitimate and reasonable, but they also, over a long period of time, change people's behavior in the marketplace.

所有这些都合情合理，但它们也会在长期内改变人们在市场中的行为。

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▶ And the market starts to take risks that end up becoming mispriced.

市场开始承担最终被错误定价的风险。

▶ And they end up that the people who are having to provide that support are going to have to provide more of it more often than what otherwise would be the case.

最终，那些必须提供支持的人将不得不比原本更频繁地提供更多支持。

▶ And that is a risk for the agricultural economy.

这对农业经济来说是一种风险。

▶ The Congress, I know, grapples with this on a consistent basis to try and determine the appropriate and most effective place level for this.

我知道，国会一直在努力解决这个问题，试图确定最合适和最有效的支持水平。

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▶ It needs to be enough to ensure that we safeguard the stuff that we think we need to safeguard for the best interests of the country, but not so much as to create bad risk-taking behavior or unsustainable subsidies or to stimulate overproduction that we don't want our need.

它需要足够确保我们为国家的最大利益保护我们认为需要保护的东西，但又不能过多，以免导致不良的风险承担行为、不可持续的补贴或刺激我们不需要的过剩生产。

▶ If we don't have a strong agriculture sector, if we can't feed ourselves, we are no longer the superpower in the world.

如果我们没有强大的农业部门，如果我们不能养活自己，我们将不再是世界上的超级大国。

▶ And so all of this, it's a complicated sort of balance that we're striking, that we're working to achieve.

因此，所有这一切都是我们正在努力实现的复杂平衡。

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▶ President Trump's Secretary of Agriculture, Brooke Rollins, has a packed travel agenda, visiting the likes of the UK and Italy and scheduling trips to India, Brazil, and Peru, all in an effort to drum up overseas interest in U.S. agriculture.

特朗普总统的农业部长布鲁克·罗林斯行程紧凑，访问了英国和意大利等国，并计划前往印度、巴西和秘鲁，所有这些都是为了激发海外对美国农业的兴趣。

▶ Specific to soybean corn, really our row croppers, that's really a very direct result of China.

特别是大豆和玉米，我们的行作作物，这确实是中国直接影响的结果。

▶ And I know we're making progress on China, we'll continue to make progress, hopefully.

我知道我们在中国问题上取得了进展，希望我们会继续取得进展。

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▶ But if we don't, opening up markets all over the world, listen, EU, for example, charges a 10% tariff on average on American products.

但如果我们不这样做，就打开世界各地的市场，比如欧盟对美国产品平均征收10%的关税。

▶ And vice versa, we only charge 5%.

反之，我们只征收5%。

▶ That's 2x.

这是两倍。

▶ The average tariff charge around the world is about 15% on American products.

世界各地对美国产品的平均关税约为15%。

▶ When we charge on average, 5%, we've been taking advantage of over and over and over again.

而我们平均只征收5%，我们一直在反复利用这一点。

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▶ So as we are realigning, we're also opening up these markets with a trade deal.

因此，在我们重新调整的同时，我们也在通过贸易协议打开这些市场。

▶ So you'll continue to see this moving forward.

所以你会继续看到这一进展。

▶ Now, if around harvest time, into the summer beginning of the fall, we see some real economic harm with our farmers.

现在，如果在收获季节，进入夏末初秋，我们看到农民遭受真正的经济损失。

▶ The president has been unequivocal, unequivocal in saying that he's got the farmers back.

总统已经明确表示，他支持农民。

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▶ And if there is short-term consequences, we'll make sure to do everything we can to mitigate that.

如果有短期后果，我们将尽一切努力减轻影响。

▶ Yet mitigation through subsidies could be detrimental to the farmers of today and the generations to come.

然而，通过补贴缓解可能会对当今和未来的农民不利。

▶ I'm a big believer that ultimately market forces are the most important thing.

我坚信，最终市场力量是最重要的。

▶ But government policy can become, can be their tailwind or a headwind or it can be sometimes it's confused and it's both at the same time.

但政府政策可以成为他们的顺风或逆风，有时它可能是混乱的，同时兼具两者。

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▶ And right now, the market forces have swung against farmers.

而现在，市场力量已经对农民不利。

▶ So you put that all together.

所以你把所有这些放在一起。

▶ It's not good business to be a farmer in America today.

如今在美国当农民并不是一门好生意。

▶ And when the business is not good, what you see is ultimately some farmers will call the day.

当生意不好时，最终你会看到一些农民选择退出。

▶ But more importantly, and I think that here is the big problem, is that we are going to see the children of those farmers deciding that farming is not their way of living.

但更重要的是，我认为这里的大问题是，我们将看到这些农民的孩子决定农业不是他们的生活方式。

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▶ Right now, I'm going to have a state I hope to come back and try some new things on the farm and continue to grow it.

现在，我希望能够回来，在农场尝试一些新事物，并继续发展它。

▶ America's history is rooted in agriculture.

美国的历史植根于农业。

▶ For JD Myers and Stu Swanson, it's run in the family for generations and their children are set to continue the tradition.

对JD Myers和Stu Swanson来说，农业是家族世代相传的事业，他们的孩子也将延续这一传统。

▶ But for the tradition to continue, they will need robust export markets for what they produce.

但要让这一传统延续下去，他们需要为其产品找到强劲的出口市场。

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▶ The technology is there, the land is fertile, but ultimately there has to be a solid business to make sure someone's around to farm it.

技术已经具备，土地也很肥沃，但最终必须有一个稳固的商业模式，以确保有人继续耕作。

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